I want to believe in your love

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/32356411.

Rating:
Explicit

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), a few others but theyre very minor

Additional Tags:
Drunk Adora (She-Ra), Disk Drunk | Infected Adora (She-Ra), relatively graphic violence, Blood and Injury, Pining, Eventual Smut, Fluff and Smut, Hurt/Comfort, Emotional Sex, POV Catra (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Light Masochism, Service Top Adora (She-Ra), kind of top adora but also not?, Alternate Universe - Canon Divergence, Canon Rewrite, no drunk sex, Implied/Referenced Self-Harm, Angst

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by fr1d4ys

Summary

After a gruesome fight between infected She-Ra and Catra in the Northern Reach, Catra finds herself isolated in a bunker with a drunk Adora, trying to wait out a raging blizzard. As Catra treats her wounds and lets down some of her walls, and as Adora sobers up, they talk. Emotions rage through the tiny bunker. causing Catra to light up with desire, and after a few moves, she finds it reciprocated by Adora.

Or

Catra deals with drunk Adora, Adora sobers up after a night and cares for Catra's wounds, and then they fuck.

Notes

So this will be a three-chapter story. The smut comes at the end so you gotta wait for it, sorry. I like porn with plots though so don't kill me. This chapter is the lightest, there is depiction of blood and wounds, though, so be warned. This is an alternate plot for S2E5 "White Out" and is based on that.

Initial Isolation

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Ugh, god, Adora, get it together ."Catra whines as she attempts to drag Adora into a small bunker. Adora is fighting her, for some reason.

"Hehehe,"Adora giggles. " *Get it together* "Adora mocks with a funny tone, wiggling her legs across the snowy ground. She's just causing more friction for Catra to fight against as she drags her. Adora isn't hurt, or anything. Why would she be? She-Ra can heal herself at any time, and so if Adora got hurt she would just transform and fix herself. But, that's beside the point, when Catra would have no chance at hurting She-Ra in the first place when she was infected.

Catra finally manages to drag Adora's entire body into the one-room bunker, and shut the door behind them. A blizzard has begun outside, they need to be in here. Even if Catra has to be alone, tormented by Adora, better yet, seemingly intoxicated Adora. Did that First Ones stone wipe out the last of her usable brain cells when it infected her or something? Because if Adora was a moron before, Catra can't even explain what she is now .

Catra stumbles over to the light switch and flips it. Staying on her feet is getting progressively harder for her. The singular lightbulb in the room flickers on, its dim, warm yellow light filling the room. The bunker is just a rectangle, four walls. One is filled up by the door, one is covered in shelves, and the other two are lined with built-in benches. Catra sighs and looks down at the useless stupid jock below her.

"Catraaaaa,"Adora starts. "I'm on the floor , when did I get here? Oh! Look!We're in a room alone together . Oooooh, are we gonna fight?

Huh Catra?”Adora laughs and rambles on as she tries to climb onto her hands and knees, and get to standing. She wobbles, but she manages to balance on her own two feet. Wow, Catra wishes that Adora was able to do that a few minutes ago.

“No, Adora. W e already did that. Sit down.”Catra demands. She is so goddamn fed up with Adora’s antics right now. It doesnt matter who or what got Adora infected, because now Catra has to deal with it and she doesnt want to. It’ s cold, too. This bunker may have a bit of insulation, but not enough for Catra.

Adora hastily steps forward to sit, slamming into Catra’s slide before she slides down, and into a bench.. Catra yelp turns into a rough hiss as Adora hits her. Cata looks to her side. She had gotten badly slashed in the fight. And oh look, it’s still pumping out blood, that’s just great. She just hopes she doesnt also have a concussion, or to make broken ribs.

“God, stay there now . Can you do that for me, Adora?”Catra asks, trying to keep her voice steady as she tries to stifle the throbbing and overwhelming pain that shoots through her. Catra just wants to sleep in a warm bed right now, but she knows she has to tend to Adora, and then her own injuries. Catra softly clutches the side of her torso as she bends down to Adora’s level. It’s an easy way to put pressure on the slash without alerting this, somehow, dumber Adora that something is wrong.

“Y es Catra, anything for youuuu.”Adora hums, closing her eyes and swaying side-to-side where she sits. As much as Catra wants to *rightfully* complain, Adora is pretty cute like this. Cute and vulnerable. Maybe this is a good time to press Adora for information on The Rebellion. Shell have to delay that idea for now , though.

As Catra moves around the bunker, looking at all the sparse shelves for supplies, she hears shuffling behind her. She turns around and is graced with Adora, slowly, slumping down and scooting off of the bench, onto the floor. Catra groans. This is so goddamn annoying. First, she has to deal with the pain screaming in her body, and

needing to actually be able to survive in this bunker for who knows how long, and now she has to deal with loopy Adora being stupid and dumb and-

Catra can hear the hard *thump* as Adora's full bodyweight hits the floor. "Owwwww , Catraaaa. Im on the floor again."Adora finally opens her eyes. Catra is standing above her, hands on her hips, eyebrows drawn in. She's pissed off, Adora deserves to know. "So soft."Adora decides to proclaim, as she crawls up on her knees to Catra's body, hands wandering to find her exposed fur. Catra yelps and flies back.

"No Adora!Hands to yourself."She yells from, now , the other side of the room. She grits her teeth at the pain the sudden movement caused. Fucking Adora, putting her on edge. Adora just looks at her, confused. She tilts her head to the side, causing her ponytail to fall awkwardly. Adora gets distracted by it because instead of actually giving Catra a response, she just fights with her ponytail like a dog trying to catch its own tail.

"Fucks sake,"Catra says under her breath as she gets up to continue her search in the bunker. "Im gonna have to deal with this all night."She manages to find a few blankets and pillows stowed away on a shelf, along with a medkit and some water bottles. Good enough for a night or so, she hopes. She sits on an adjacent bench to the one Adora is, almost, sitting in by now. She managed to wrestle her hair tie out of her hair, and somehow managed to start sweating in the process.

"You gonna sober up anytime soon now, Adora?"Catra asks. She wants to tend to her own wounds, but she doesnt want to have to undress in front of Adora. Especially when she's like this. Catra looks down at her hands. The fur on her palms is matted with dried blood. She grabs her water bottle and starts to untwist the lid with shaking hands.

"Whyre you shaking?"Adora questions, shifting closer to Catra. Her words are still slurred, but at least she sounds cognitive.

"None of your goddamn business." Catra represses a snarl as she speaks. She knows Adora didn't mean to hurt her, but god, does she still feel the pain. She finally gets her water open and chugs it, downing most of it in seconds. She can feel the liquid travel down her dry throat. It's a nice contrast to the chilling air she was heaving in outside.

"Soft kitty needs help?" Adora, for some stupid reason, asks as she reaches out with her grabby hands at Catra. "I can help, pleeease." Adora begs wildly as she stands from her seat, followed by tripping over herself, catching herself on the wall, and then sliding across it to sit next to Catra. How graceful.

"Hm." Catra cannot believe she is actually considering this. It would be hard to bandage up her side, though, especially with her hands shaking like this. At least she knows Adora won't hurt her now. She doesn't have the mental capacity to. It's still scary, being so vulnerable in front of the enemy. But what else is she going to do? "Show me your hands."

Adora flings her hands out to Catra, palms up. Adora had thrust them so hard forward they hit Catra in the chest. Catra involuntarily hisses, but it doesn't seem to affect Adora in the slightest, so she resumes eyeing her enemy's stilled and soft hands in front of her.

"Hmmmmmm," Adora responds. "Like what you see, kitty?" She laughs, to the point of snorting. It fills the room with a feeling of happiness, despite their grim situation. "Huuuh!" Adora continues, taking a deep breath before Catra can stop her. "Boop!"

Catra has never been more furious in her entire life. Adora's fingertip is sitting on Catra's nose. This is dehumanizing, demoralizing, just absolutely terrible. And yet, for some reason, Catra doesn't move Adora's hand away.

"Soft nose." Adora states, loudly. It hurts a bit, and Catra's ears flex back to try and rid some of the noise. "Soft ears?" Adora takes both of her hands and rests them atop Catra's pushed-back ears. Catra

knows they're incredibly soft, and Adora finds out. "Oh my god! Soft ears! Soft ears!" Adora proclaims, cheers even, as she sets to petting Catra's ears.

Catra sinks into the affection for a moment, before realizing who and what is happening. She surges up, grabs Adora's wrists, and narrows her eyes. "Not for you. No soft ears for you." She tries. Maybe this simple language will get through Adora's thick skull.

It does. Too much. Adora starts crying almost immediately. Tears welling up in her eyes, to then already having a waterfall of them come crashing down her face as she bawls in front of Catra. She is just sitting there, Adora's wrists in her hands, watching her cry. What the fuck is she supposed to do to stop her from crying?

"Adora." Catra begins. She hopes this works. "If you want to touch my soft ears, you have to do something for me first, okay?" Catra lets go of Adora's wrists and opens the medkit. She needs to get this over with already. The bleeding has slowed, it's still an open wound bleeding nonetheless. Adora accepts, eagerly nodding her head and aggressively wiping her tears off her face, sniffling strongly to pull back everything that just came out.

Catra takes out a large bandage wrap and some tape and sets it on the bench beside them. She really doesn't want to have to resort to something like this. She stands from her seat, unzips her large puffy jacket that is not fashioned with a giant rip in the side, and puts it down. The cold instantly hits her bare arms. She shivers and looks herself up and down. Her arms are a little scratched and bruised up, but not bad. She looks to her side and finds her shirt cut and ripped wide open revealing her fur and injury. The shirt is covered in dried and wet blood, and so is her fur. She hates that sensation, of something dried up and stuck in her fur, especially when that causes the smell of blood to linger on her for longer. It brings back memories that she hates.

Adora is sitting on the bench, looking up at her with wide eyes. She looks surprised and hopeful, maybe? It's a strange look. Catra scoffs

and turns away. Here comes the *fun* part. She gently takes the hem of her shirt and pulls it over her head. She winces at the movement. Her body is starting to really ache, the adrenaline wearing off. She tosses the shirt to the side. Normally, she would have just sliced it off with her claws, but she wants to actually preserve the fabric. Catra holds her arms with her hands, trying to warm and comfort herself in a hug, and turns around to face Adora.

"W ow," Adora slurs, reaching out with grabby hands once more. This time, it makes Catra blush. With the insinuation of her being topless, hands like that can mean much more. Adora is eyeing Catra intensely, and then she starts to giggle to herself. "I get to see Catra nakedddd!" She sings.

"No! I am not naked Adora!" Catra yells back. She grips her arms harder to try and control herself. Trying to start a fight with Adora right now is a bad idea.

"Naked Catra, naked Catra," Adora hums as she rocks back and forth in her seat.

"Shut up Adora," Catra groans, sitting down next to her once more. Adora squeaks in response. "Let' s get this over with, then you can touch my ears, okay?"

"Y our super soft ears? The soft ones?" Adora nervously asks. Her hands twitching in her lap with delight.

"I only have one pair of ears, Adora." Catra begins to prepare the supplies, pausing to look up at Adora. Adora looks stressed, scared even. "Y es." Catra adds. "The soft ones."

"Y ay! Soft!" Adora claps in delight.

Catra hates this. But, in a way, it's fun to watch Adora be so loose. She is usually always wound up tight, stressed out of her mind, Catra notices even if she's fighting her across a battlefield. Anyone would be able to see it from a mile away. But, from Catra's

perspective at least, it doesn't seem like anyone in The Rebellion does anything about it.

"Give me your hands." Catra demands. Adora gratefully pushes her hands out for Catra to do whatever she wants with. "Here," She says as she gives Adora the bandage. "I'm going to clean it, then you're going to wrap this around me where I say so, okay?"

"Yes! Then I will pet the soft kitty!" Adora replies with her eyes closed. She hasn't retracted her hands from Catra' s space. Adora has a giant smile plastered over her face.

Catra sighs. That was the deal, after all. Catra takes the last of her water bottle and pours it over the side of her stomach, where the gash is. It's hard to see how wide or deep it is because of her fur, but she will know soon enough. It stings. Catra bites her tongue to hold back from hissing at nothing. The pain radiates out of the wound and through the rest of her body, forcing her hands to shake harder. She takes her shirt, balls it up in her hand, and wipes it around the cut. This hurts a lot goddamn more than just the water did. A small noise of pain somehow manages to escape Catra's throat, even though she tried to keep it down with all her might.

"Catra?" Adora's voice softly enters Catra' s conscious brain. Then, she feels a hand touch her shoulder.

Catra hisses at the contact, jumping back and hitting her head on the wall. She grits her teeth and groans at the pain that lights up all over her body. "Fuck me! Jesus christ. Don't do that Adora!" Catra raises her voice, out of breath. Everything is starting to hurt. She can't figure out which place she should clutch with her hands to try and relieve pain. Her ribs? Her cut? Her head? Plus all the little places there's too many to count.

"I'm sorry ." Adora wilts. She' s so animated when she's loopy like this. Adora's entire body hunches, her shoulders rounding, her face twisting into sadness and guilt. It's a lot to watch.

“Just, don’t do that without asking,” Catra says, trying to chill her anger. She has adjusted back to continue cleaning her wound. Once she finishes, or once it’s good enough to bandage up, she looks up at Adora. She hasn’t moved at all really. Everything in Adora’s body is still wilting.

“Adora,” Catra calls, “You need to bandage me up now.”

Adora immediately lights back up, sitting straight with a smile appearing on her face. She holds the bandage out to Catra’s stomach expectantly.

Catra begins. “You need to wrap it over this cut,” She points to the gash on her side. It’s deeper than she had wanted it to be. Well, she didn’t want one at all, but she at least hoped it would end up being shallow. “Then around my body, and loop it like that until you run out of bandage. Then, keep your hand there so I can tape it so it doesn’t fall off. You need to make the bandage kind of tight, okay?”

Adora nods quickly. She sets to pressing the bandage over Catra’s side, but she flinches. Adora stops in her tracks, looking up to make eye contact with Catra. “Just, keep going. Don’t stop unless I say to stop.” Catra clarifies.

Adora finally sets the bandage over Catra’s wound. Catra gasps a little, and that gasp turns into a wince at the pain. She digs her claws into the wall next to them to release the energy. Adora continues.

“Okay,” Catra releases a big breath after Adora has wrapped the whole bandage around her. Adora has her hands pressed against Catra’s stomach. Adora’s hands are so warm, and for what? To make her more enticing? “Keep your hands there, I need to tape it.” Catra gets out the tape, slices a few pieces off with her claws, and tapes the bandage to itself so it won’t unravel. Adora has yet to move her hands.

“All done?” Adora questions, looking up at Catra. Adora’s eyes are big and prideful, her mouth quirks up into a small smile beneath her.

"Yes, good job." Catra replies. She pats Adora on the head in reward. Adora hums in happiness as Catra does so. "You can take your hands away now."

"And I can pet the soft kitty, like this?" Adora asks. She looks Catra's body up and down. She's still shirtless, and she was planning to put it back on. But, Adora's hands are really warm. Maybe having them on her will feel nicer than a shirt anyway.

"Let me make up some beds for us first." Catra says. She doesn't want to have to get up again once she lies down. It's probably night, anyway. It doesn't matter, really, Catra is tired as hell and would fall asleep no matter what time it was.

Adora whines loudly and takes her hands off of Catra's stomach. "Ughhhhh," Adora complains, "But I wanted to snuggle and touch the SOFT EARS!" Her voice skyrockets as she talks about Catra.

Catra stares at Adora in awe. She wants to *snuggle?* Did she really just say that? Catra wonders if Adora will remember this. If she does, Catra acting like this will prove an obvious weakness, and The Rebellion could use that against her easily. But, if she doesn't remember it, maybe doing something like that wouldn't be so bad, Catra sighs.

"How're you feeling, princess? Still loopy and stupid?" She asks, poking Adora's forehead with her finger.

"Yessss. Soft kitty. I like it when you touch meeee." Adora explains. Catra's jaw drops. *What the fuck?* Adora must be lying, or out of her goddamn mind. But, why would Adora lie right now, about this? Is she even capable of lying in this state?

"You do?" Catra gives into her curiosity. She might never get a chance to be this close and safe next to Adora again.

"Mhmmm, I want more. Gimme." Adora hums to herself. She is shifting closer to Catra now. Adora's eyes are dancing with

happiness and purity. Catra, as mean as she might be, cannot kill that look.

"Tell you what, Adora," Catra scoots a little farther away as she speaks. "If you make up some comfy beds on the floor for us, I will let you pet me *wherever* you want." Catra gestures to the floor. The benches are really skinny, and Catra doesn't want to fall off if she rolls around in the night, so the floor is better.

Adora beams at her, shooting up to standing and wobbling for a moment, before gaining balance and collecting blankets and pillows. She looks so determined, her face set with a mix of anticipation and focus. Adora loves being helpful, and Catra loves telling other people what to do. Match made in heaven, right?

Adora finishes making something for them. Catra wouldn't really call it *two* beds. It's more like one large nest of fluffiness. Catra adores nests like this. She makes them out of blankets in her empty bed at The Horde, especially when she is missing Adora. Sometimes, she even makes a mass of blankets at the top of the bed to simulate *her*, and Catra curls up at the foot of it. It wasn't like having true Adora there, though. There are no sounds of breathing, body heat, or the occasional twitch that would comfort Catra so much in the night.

Catra slowly stands, holding onto the wall as she does so. Any strengthening adrenaline she had has worn off. Pain, soreness, and exhaustiveness has filled her body. "This looks," Catra pauses to think it over before actually telling Adora. "Comfortable. Good." She settles on saying.

She wanted to say it looks like home. Home isn't with The Horde, it's with Adora.

"YES! Snuggle time!" Adora yelps. She tackles Catra into the mass of blankets beneath them. As much as Catra would normally love that, she hits the ground and it shakes her to her bones. She groans and whines in pain as her body tries to settle after being thrown

around *again* . Catra opens her eyes to find Adora staring down at her, tears welling up. "Oh no"…

"Please, Adora, don't be rough." Catra basically *whimpers* below her enemy. She knows she didn't mean to hurt her again. "Don't cry . Ugh, Adora." Catra tries to force down her pain. Adora can't deal with her, she can't even deal with herself. Whining about her own pain won't get her anywhere.

"I will fix it," Adora replies, gaze suddenly turning fiery with determination. "Yes. I will. Kiss it make it better ." Adora says quietly to herself. Catra doesn't have time to react, she's so tired, after all. Her instincts are worn out.

She watches Adora bolt down to Catra's rib cage, just under one of her breasts, and kisses it, softly. It is filled with affection, with healing, with want and with care. Catra gasps at the sensation. It sets a fire off inside of her body that shoots and settles between her legs. She unwillingly clenches her thighs together, suddenly realizing that Adora is moving *down* , still cluttering Catra's body with kisses. Catra's stomach is filled with butterflies, she can't believe this is happening right now. Maybe, when Adora was infected and violent, she actually killed Catra and that is why she's experiencing this.

Catra sharply inhales as Adora kisses her hip bone, just above the hem of her pants. She needs to stop this. Adora isn't going to do anything *real* when she's like this, and Catra doesn't want to be left hanging too badly. She's already horribly turned on, her face must be a dark red by now. "Adora," Catra whines, her voice seems to be made mostly of air at this point.

Adora lifts up her head, looking up at Adora from her pelvis. God, does she look good there. Adora makes a confused look on her face. She doesn't know what she's doing now, does she? That makes it so much worse for Catra. She doesn't want to take advantage of Adora this way, even if this is her only chance in hell to get anything like this from her.

“What about you just pet me. Thank you for the kisses, princess.” Catra struggles to make her voice steady, but she forces it well enough for Adora to not question it. Well, honestly, Catra isn't sure if Adora would question it even if her voice was shaking with desire.

Adora giggles and moves back up towards Catra’s face. Catra is laid out in the nest of softness, Adora sitting criss-cross next to her. “Okay!” Adora happily complies. She begins running her hands through the fur on Catra’s bare stomach. Her hands fall across, petting, and then scratching lightly deeper into her fur. Catra closes her eyes to relax into it.

Sure, maybe Catra is still hellishly turned on, but she can ignore it for this. Adora’s hands wander up Catra’s torso, narrowly avoiding her breasts as she pets. Even loopy Adora must have enough common sense to understand that touching her tits is a lot, and Catra is so fucking thankful for it. She wouldn't be able to handle it if Adora did that, she would snap and pin Adora down in a second. Adora’s hands fall to Catra’s face. Adora gently holds her, running her thumbs through the thickened fur on her cheeks. Catra hears a little *gasp* come from Adora before she feels hands come to pet her ears, her soft ears.

At some point, Catra started purring. She doesn't exactly know when it started, but it did. Catra’s hands knead at the blanket she’s laying on, and her tail is swaying happily. Adora seems to notice because Catra can hear the few sounds of happiness, shock, and surprised ‘*oh!*’ sounds Adora makes every so often.

Catra is about to fall asleep. Her eyelids are heavy, and every time she opens them to check on Adora (she’s usually just staring in awe as she pets through Catra’s fur) it becomes harder to keep them there. Adora’s hands are warm and comforting. They're calloused from Adora’s training, but still soft. They are placed and manipulated with care, Catra can tell. Catra wiggles around in the sheets a little, causing Adora to rip her hands away. That saddens her, Adora must be so worried about doing something wrong. Catra turns onto her

good side and curls up a bit, then she opens one eye to stare at Adora.

Adora is looking down at her with nervousness, she's unsure what to do. She's holding her hands out awkwardly, prepared to continue but hesitant. Catra simply grabs Adora's shoulder and yanks her down to lie in the nest with her. Adora blinks rapidly, now face to face with Catra.

"We're going to sleep now." Catra tells her. It isn't a request. Adora is deathly still, unmoving next to Catra. It bothers her, just sitting there, so far apart yet so close. She can feel Adora's breath on her nose. Catra makes a noise of displeasure, and grabs Adora's waist, weakly pulling her in. She entangles their legs together, bringing Adora chest-to-chest with her. Catra moves Adora's hands around to her back, letting her continue to pet through her fur.

Adora scrambles even closer to Catra, pressing into her a bit. Adora's chin is resting atop Catra's head. She always was taller, so it just makes sense like this, Catra tries to convince herself of that as she denies the fact that it feels safe like this.

~

The first thing Catra notices when she starts to become conscious again is snoring. Great. She's starting off her morning with loud noises *right* next to her ear. As her brain slowly comes to terms with waking up, she realizes where she is. Her eyes rip open, and she looks around the bunker that she fell asleep in. *Oh fuck*. She recalls last night and everything that happened. For some reason, she really figured that Adora would be gone by the time she woke up, or maybe, that she wouldn't wake up at all. But now, the loud noise machine next to her is *Adora.*

Catra's body starts to slowly feel sensations again. She's still so sleepy, it's probably because her body is taking so much energy to heal her wounds. She feels soft hands around her, and fingers mindlessly rubbing gently into her skin. It feels calming and safe. She is surrounded by Adora's scent, and it smells like *home* . Catra feels Adora's body behind her, their legs intertwined together, and Catra's back pressed against Adora's chest. Catra is being held with the utmost amount of care.

Suddenly, Adora stops snoring. Catra starts to panic. Is she waking up? Has she already woken up? Her heart rate speeds up. It bangs in her chest, in her head. Catra doesnt move an inch. She wouldnt dare. She needs Adora to think she's asleep. Maybe Adora will just leave Catra to rest and go back to all her new *best friends* . Then Catra doesnt actually have to deal with anything that just happened, and they never have to mention it again. Will Adora even remember last night? Will she still be loopy and stupid? Or maybe -

Adora makes a noise. "Mmmmh." It' s airy and soft. Adora wiggles closer to Catra, pulling her in and snuggling more.

Catra needs to get herself together. She has slept in the same bed with Adora for years, their entire lives basically. She knows her tells. Adora is stirring awake, that must be it. It's strange, though. When they used to sleep in the same bed together, Catra would usually curl up at the foot of it. Sometimes they would sleep next to each other, but that was only when it was really cold. It was for survival, nothing more. Nonetheless, it was always nice. Sometimes, Catra would wish that a winter storm would hit, and make it cold so they would sleep next to one another. Sometimes they would wake up like this, one person holding the other, but it felt *different* before.

Adora wakes more. She starts to wiggle closer again, her hands start to move a little, and clutch at Catra's fur. "Mmm, Catra?" Adora whispers questioningly . She is running her hands up and down Catra's exposed fur now.

Catra doesnt know what to say . It’s obvious its her , right? There arent a lot of other brown magicats running around and getting stuck in bunkers. "Y es?"She finally says.

Adora lets out a breath and relaxes into Catra’s back. "Catra,"She repeats. This time its more of a declaration, a comfort to herself. After a moment, where Catra can only guess Adora’s brain is warming up and gears are starting to turn, Adora jumps up from Catra’s side. She scrambles up to standing and looks down at Catra below her. Catra only turns slightly, glaring at her.

Adora’s eyes widen and she points straight down at Catra. "Catra?!" Her jaw gapes open, shock written all over her face. Catra looks down at herself for a moment, realizing that she is still very topless. Adora mustve noticed too, based on the blush crowding her face. At least the loopiness mustve worn of f, or fixed itself, or something.

"Adora."Catra deadpans back. She’ s too tired for this. She was so comfortable, and Adora had to go and ruin it.

"What. What happened?!"Adora practically yells, still staring at Catra intensely.

"Do you remember?"Catra shifts more. She doesnt know if she *wants* Adora to remember or not. She gently props herself onto her elbows while lying on her back, still looking up at Adora. She really doesnt want to hurt herself by trying to get up.

"I-"Adora hesitates. She slumps down a little where she stands, less guarded than before. "Maybe. I dont know . It’s foggy."Adora looks around the room, taking in the small space around them. Catra watches. It hurts to move anyway, so she’s pretty unmotivated to. "I remember you dragging me in here."As Adora speaks, Catra now knows that she does *not* want Adora to remember. Catra was vulnerable, weak, and let down her walls. She let Adora touch her, comfort her. And she showed care for Adora when she was unable to care for herself. This is not something Catra wants Adora to know.

"Yeah, because you were all stupid and you were going to freeze out there. I wasn't going to let you get off that easily." Catra scoffs as she desperately tries to bring her emotional walls back up around her. "I did not save you because I *like* you, get that straight in your head. I did it so I can bring you back to The Horde myself. Without you, The Rebellion will fall. Simple as that, princess, got it?"

Adora stammers. Catra doesn't want to talk about what happened last night. By the way Adora looks down at her, her eyes filled with hope and silently pleading, she must remember *enough* to understand how they fell asleep next to each other and how Adora woke up holding her.

Adora starts to look, really *look* at Catra, which she apparently wasn't doing before, because she gasps when she notices the bandage wound around Catra's abdomen. It's stained red around her side, where her cut is. She must've bled more during the night. It was probably Adora's fault for cuddling her too hard. Adora slowly comes back down to Catra's level, landing on her knees. "What happened?" She asks, looking at Catra's bloodied bandage.

"You." Catra forces out. "You happened."

Chapter End Notes

Thank you so much for reading this chapter :) This is my first multi-chapter story, so I hope it goes well. Ill post the next chapter in a day or two. If you want any more updates, I sometimes post on my tumblr: fr1d4ys

Red Stained Snow

Chapter Notes

> This one is the violent chapter. I personally dont think its too bad, but Im pretty desensitized so Im not sure. Theres a fair amount of blood but nothing too graphic, stay safe guys :)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Entrapta hands Catra a 3-pointed-star shaped crystal thing. Catra takes it and looks down at it. Entrapta had said that it was influential over She-Ra, and possibly Adora as well. How influential? She doesnt know . But, Catra is willing to find out.

"From looking at the scanner here, She-Ra is coming in close! About 2 minutes before she arrives! This is going to be so exciting, Im going to collect so much data!" Entrapta beams as she eyes the horizon from which She-Ra and her group of *besties* will arrive from.

"Yeah whatever, I just hope this stupid thing works," Catra says, looking in the same place as Entrapta is. Scorpia is somewhere in the Northern Reach lab area, or buildings, but Catra doesnt know , or really care, where. She can handle this herself.

After staring at the dark snowy horizon for what feels like hours, Catra sees some golden hair start to edge over. She's here. This is it. Entrapta is staring intensely ahead as well, her voice recorder out and ready.

"This better fucking work." Catra glares at Entrapta, a silent warning, before she pockets the crystal and comes out of her hiding spot, giving herself away to The Rebellion.

~

"Catra," Adora declares, she is approaching Catra with Glimmer and Bow by her sides. She is staggering in her She-Ra form as always.

Catra smiles and chuckles. "Hey , Adora. Pretty far from home, arent you?"

"You are too. Shadow Weaver must've thrown you out here after you *lost* The Battle of Brightmoon, huh?" Adora must be feeling chatty today, maybe wound up. Usually, she doesnt go for Catra' s emotions like this.

"Oh please. You've missed so much, princess. Things are" Catra starts to walk in a large circle around the group. "Dif ferent now." She looks down at her hands, unsheathing her claws and looking at them with anticipation.

"We've come to take back this territory . It doesnt belong to you or The Horde!" Adora yells, bringing her sword up into the air . She was always dramatic.

Catra faces She-Ra, and brandishes her arms out to her sides. "T ake it, then, if you can."

Adora immediately takes the opening, and throws herself at Catra, completely ignoring her friends that she left in the dust. Catra just jumps back a little and then runs on all fours to get away from the others. She isnt here for anyone else besides Adora.

"Adora!" Someone yells from behind as she is chasing Catra. Catra hears a *fwoosh* sound and a pink, bubbly mess teleports next to Adora's side. "I'm not letting you do this alone." Glimmer says, filled with confidence as she stares straight into Catra.

Catra groans. "Really , I have to deal with you *and* Sparkles?" A two versus one fight is pretty unfair, even for Adora's standards. But, who knows, maybe her standards have changed since she left. Catra

knows that once the crystal hits Adora's sword, something will happen, at least she hopes. That has to be her goal.

"Just give up, Catra. Then this can all be over."Adora pleads. She acts like giving up is *easy* . She acts like it's a good thing.

"Give up and miss out on winning this fight?"Catra laughs performatively. "Why would I want to do something like that?"And as her sentence ends, Catra launches at She-Ra with as much power as she can muster. Catra cant even begin to imagine how much She-Ra outweighs her, so she needs strength to try and knock her down.

Adora only stumbles a little, as Catra clings to her body, digging her claws into her shoulders. Adora whimpers in pain, and grabs Catra by the shoulders, and throws her off. Catra flies, just a little, before plummeting into the snowy ground. She's a little dizzy as she hears footsteps crunching in the snow. She adjusts to look straight up and sees She-Ra's glowing eyes staring right back down at her. Catra's view is obstructed by *sword* . Adora's sword pointing down at Catra's neck. She can see Glimmer standing somewhere behind Adora.

"Oh!That's cute."Catra chuckles into the metal blade that's almost touching her. "You wish you could, dont you princess?"She asks, her voice is dripping with disappointment. Who is she disappointed in? She doesnt know .

Adora hesitates above her. Perfect. Catra quickly reaches into her pocket, grabs the First Ones crystal, and slaps it into the blue eye of Adora's sword. Instantly, the sword's crystal is filled with red, and red vines grow along the handle and up the hilt. She-Ra steps away and screams, clutching her head. Catra scrambles back. What the hell is this?

Glimmer screams with Adora, but out of fear and anger , not pain. "What the fuck did you do, Catra?!"

Adora yells. Her yell is not properly pitched, it sounds almost mechanical. It is filled with anger and excitement, two things you don't see at the same time very often. She-Ra opens her eyes, and they are blood red. She-Ra's mouth twists up into a manic grin, as she brings up her sword and tries to trust it down upon Catra.

Catra jumps away, digging her claws into the snow. It doesn't provide a lot of traction. She-Ra sets out to try to fight Glimmer, since she's closer now.

"Adora, stop! I know you're still in there! Get a hold of yourself!" Glimmer screams as she dodges and teleports around She-Ra's attacks.

She-Ra only laughs in amusement, the smile on her face never leaving, as she swings her sword faster and harder. Catra watches. She wants to believe this is good, this is what she wanted. She wanted She-Ra and Adora to be different, or just messed up. But, what happened to Adora? Is she still in there? Will she be like this too? The world around the three is starting to disappear into whiteness. *Fuck.* A blizzard must be coming. A cold wind blows straight through Catra and her jacket, shaking her bones.

Finally, She-Ra manages to strike Glimmer. It was only She-Ra's fist that made contact, but it shot Glimmer across the snowy floor. As Glimmer lays in the snow, slowly trying to pry herself up and out of it, She-Ra stomps up behind her.

Catra hates herself, especially for what she's about to do. She-Ra lifts her sword in the air, ready to pierce through Glimmer, but she is stopped by claws ripping down her back. She-Ra yells in anger, and turns around. This is when Catra truly realizes how bad of an idea this was when she looks up and meets She-Ra's eyes that are filled with violence. Catra's not supposed to be the self-sacrificing one. She's not supposed to be the nice one who saves other people, she should've just left Glimmer there and let fate handle it.

Catra quickly turns around, lets herself return to all fours, and starts to run. But god, when She-Ra really wants her way, she seems to get it. As if She-Ra didn't even have to try, Catra feels her ankle grabbed and her body rise off the ground. She-Ra's grip on her is horribly painful, and Catra lets out a shaking yell. As She-Ra brings her up, Catra tries to scratch and claw at her face and shoulders, maybe arms, anything she can reach. But She-Ra only grabs Catra harder, using her other hand to grip Catra's wrist, and then she manages to grab the other, and forces them together. Catra is at She-Ra's mercy, and she hates it. She doesn't recognize the woman before her. She grunts and squirms, trying to get out of She-Ra's grasp, but it is no use. The more Catra moves, the harder She-Ra holds. Catra vaguely wonders if her bones will break under the pressure.

Suddenly, She-Ra throws her, like a doll, forward and into the ground. Catra doesn't land properly and twists her already injured ankle. She flips to look up and sees She-Ra's figure above her.

"Adora wait, please!" Catra begs. She doesn't want to die, not yet, not at the hands of *her.* Catra is breathing hard, and each inhale of the freezing air burns her lungs. She feels like this is a dream. She can see nothing but white around her and She-Ra, since the blizzard has already progressed so badly. She-Ra moves her sword and presses it into Catra's side. *Holy shit.* Catra feels the blade easily cut through her jacket, her shirt, and then straight into her skin as She-Ra presses harder and swipes it across her. Catra can feel her skin part as she screams. She is met with a feeling of warmth and cold at the same time. The cold weather around them sinks into Catra's cut clothes, but the warmth of her blood covers her skin.

She-Ra cackles above Catra and grabs her ankle. She begins to forcibly drag Catra through the snow. It hurts. It hurts so bad. She can feel her heartbeat in her cut side. Catra's exposed skin is turning numb and getting scratched by stray rocks hidden in the snow. She is being dragged on her stomach. She looks up and watches her blood stain the perfectly white snow as she is dragged. It makes a

clear trail. Catra tries to struggle, absently tries to move around and escape, but she knows she is just wasting energy. Where is She-Ra taking her?

It doesnt take Catra long to find out. She finds herself being flung, once again, but this time instead of landing in relatively soft snow, her back slams into the side of a rock. Catra screams with the little air she has left in her lungs as pain ripples through her entire body. It shakes her insides, her stomach turns and her bones feel brittle. Her eyes prick with tears. Somewhere in Catra's mind, she wonders if her tears will turn to ice.

Catra's legs give out beneath her. She slides down the jagged wall and hits the ground. She brings her weak arm over to clutch at her bleeding side. She looks ahead and watches She-Ra's shadowy figure turn into a real woman as she stomps closer. The blizzard blocks the view of anything that's far away. How far did She-Ra really throw her?

"Adora." Catra struggles out the words. Everything hurts. Everything is cold. Her head is fuzzy from the impact on the rock. Saying her name is probably useless.

Catra's back rests on the rock, her legs splayed forward in front of her. Catra's vision is once again obscured by She-Ra's sword. The tip of it is almost touching her nose. Catra can hear She-Ra's ragged breathing.

Catra looks up, and tries to make eye contact with her, although everything is a little blurry. "Do it." She demands. "Like how you always wanted." She closes her eyes. She didnt want to die this way, but everything is already so numb from the cold, so maybe it wont hurt too bad anyway .

Catra hears yelling, it sounds distressed. She opens her eyes to find the sword gone, and She-Ra clutching at her head once more. She's yelling, and it's growing louder, turning into screaming. The sound pierces through Catra's sensitive ears and it feels like knives in her

brain. She-Ra throws her sword. It stabs into the ground a few feet away from her. She falls to her knees, still clutching her head. Catra watches She-Ra's form glow, stutter, and then Adora falls to the ground.

~

Catra blinks. She's sure that the impact from the rock must've killed her or something, because this is not happening. Catra crawls over to Adora's body, lying still and facedown in the snow. It hurts so badly to move, and moving might cause her to bleed out more, but Catra's heart is beating so fast and she's full of adrenaline, and she needs to find out if Adora is dead or not;if Catra killed her or not. She kneels next to Adora and turns her over by the shoulder. Adora's face is covered in snow, her mouth open, eyes closed. Catra starts to panic. Adora cant be dead, not like that. She doesnt look like she has any injuries. There werent any claw marks on her or blood on her clothes. Finally, Catra presses the side of her head to Adora's chest, and she hears her heartbeat and feels her chest rise and fall with life.

"Thank god, Adora."Catra nervously laughs as the words leave her throat. She's so glad that Adora couldnt hear that.

She notices that Adora is wearing her regular clothes, no winter jacket or boots. She must be freezing. Catra looks around, which she finds is entirely unhelpful. It's just whiteness all around them. She can still see the rock from which she crawled over from, along with a red stain painted on the side of it, but thats all. At least Adora is unconscious, so she wont have to witness Catra' s weakness. Catra struggles onto her feet and looks around once more. She doesnt want to leave Adora and find somewhere to hunker down alone, she might lose her. And so, Catra bends down and hooks her hands under Adora's body, and begins to drag. She manages everything

with great effort and pain. She just hopes that nothing is ruptured and she's not bleeding too profusely. She drags Adora around to one of the sides of the rock and then sets her back down.

Adora wiggles a little bit, and she makes a *happy* noise. Maybe she's dreaming, or something. Why the hell would someone be dreaming of good things after a fight like that?

Catra notices a faint outline of something boxy in the distance. It must be relatively close if she can see it in this weather. She takes a deep inhale of what feels like pure ice, and she grabs Adora and starts dragging her again, walking backward to the object. Then, Adora wakes up.

Adora immediately starts kicking her legs around, trying to wrestle herself out of Catra's grip. Either Adora isnt trying that hard, or she is just really weak. She giggles as she does so.

"Ugh, god, Adora, get it together ."

Chapter End Notes

> Thank you again for reading and I want to thank everyone who left a comment on the last chapter, I read all of them and really appreciate you guys :) The next chapter will be a lot longer than this one, but Ill try to get it posted in a few days

Fool Me With Your Fake Love

Chapter Notes

> this is, in all three, the comfort, smut, and angst chapter, so enjoy
> CW for a bit of blood and a bit of self-harm (there isnt intent to self-harm, its more of an emotional response in which that happens) - neither of these happen during the smut btw

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Y ou."Catra forces out. "Y ou happened."

Adora looks up and into Catra's eyes. Adora's face looks distraught, her lips slightly parted and her eyes are pleading and nervous. "I did this to you?"She whispers. She looks back down at Catra' s bandage, and tentatively reaches a hand out to touch it.

A growl starts from inside of Catra. She doesnt know where it came from. She isnt actually that scared of Adora, is she? Adora quickly pulls her hand back, her eyes are starting to water.

"I'm so sorry Catra, I".Adora stutters out words. As her eyes look over Catra's body once more, Catra suddenly feels very exposed. Adora isnt loopy and fun like she was last night, Catra cant risk being like this in front of her.

Catra tries to scoot away from Adora. She winces as she tries to move, her body screaming at her to stay still. Adora gasps and reaches out to help Catra, only to be stopped by a glare. "I dont need *your* help."Catra grumbles out. Adora must pity her , must feel sorry for her weakness, and that makes Catra angry. She is weak, she believes that, but no one else has to know. Adora pulls back, once more.

"Catra,"Adora pleads, "Let me help you. Last night you-"

"Shut up! We're not talking about it!" Catra bursts back. She's pissed off. After Catra dragged Adora's limp body to safety, this is how she repays her? With a fucking interrogation? Catra climbs up to her feet. She's done. She's going to leave. At least, that was her plan before she realized that standing up that fast, while dehydrated and healing, was a terrible idea. The world spins around her and her knees buckle beneath her. She manages one last thought: *oh fuck* , before darkness creeps into her vision and takes her whole.

~

Catra slowly starts to wake up and feels that she's reflexively kneading into something. It's soft and squishy , a good texture to knead into. Catra flexes her claws out, presses her pads into the surface, and retracts her claws once more. It feels nice.

Catra hears a sharp inhale near her, and it isn't hers. She twitches her ear towards the noise. It's Adora. She knows that logically, and it sounds like her, but she wants to pretend she's still asleep. That makes everything so much easier. But, instead, Catra's curiosity wins, and she opens her eyes. *Thighs* . That is all she can see. Her chin is resting on Adora's upper thigh, while her hands are kneading into her other one. Catra flexes her hands back and slowly pulls them away. Adora's pant leg is ripped up a little bit, and she has some scratches and a few little pricks with blood coming out, but it's basically nothing. Catra's body is splayed out behind her, resting on her stomach.

"You awake?" Adora asks. Obviously , she is, but it's nice for Adora to ask anyway. Catra doesn't feel like she slammed into the floor or anything. Adora's hero complex probably forced her to catch Catra instead of letting her hit the ground.

Catra makes a noise of acknowledgment, a noise of *yes, and I dont want to be* . Adora lets out a soft sigh, and starts petting over Catra's ears and head. Catra desperately wants to rip herself away, yell at Adora, tell her that she doesnt need her or her help or her sympathy or *anything* . But, she's tired, and Adora's hands feel nice. Who knows how long theyll be stuck in here anyway? Plus, Adora remembers everything from last night, so Catra has already shown her cards. She might as well go all the way and bask in the affection while she can have it.

"I need you to get up so you can drink some water ."Adora softly says. Her voice sounds so caring, filled with genuine concern. Catra isnt used to that, not anymore. It' s been a while since someone made her feel like they give a fuck.

Nonetheless, Catra doesnt like being easy . "Dont want to move." Catra replies. She has rested her stilled hands across Adora's thigh again.

Adora withdraws her hands from Catra's ears. Catra lets out an involuntary noise of disappointment at the loss of contact. "W ell, fine then. If youre not gonna let me help you then youre not getting anything."Adora crosses her arms over her chest, and releases a *hmph* .

Catra starts kneading into Adora's thigh again. This is all she needs. She would rather have this than get up. "Okay , whatever."Catra buries her head into one of Adora's thighs, and continues. Claws flexing, pads pressing, claws unflexing.

She hears Adora move slightly above her. Catra continues, unbothered. After another few cycles of kneading, she feels Adora's hips shift beneath her, and Adora's thighs flexing together for a moment as Adora lets out a soft, almost unnoticeable, noise. A normal person wouldnt have heard it, but Catra has impressive hearing and has been listening intently. Catra brings her head out of the comfortable space she's made to look at Adora.

Her face is flush and darkened as she looks down and makes eye contact with Catra. Adora is propping herself up on her hands that rest behind her back. Her lips are slightly parted, and her soft breath comes just a little unsteady. Adora's eyes widen and she shuts her mouth. It's too late, Catra already knows what was happening to Adora. Catra continues to stare into Adora's eyes as she flexes her hands, claws slightly unsheathed, into Adora's thigh once more. This time, adding a little more pressure and sharpness. Adora gasps at the sensation as her thighs twitch together once more.

Catra grins. She likes this. Finally, she can do *something* to affect Adora. Adora is getting turned on by *her* . This is exciting, it's new . It doesn't matter how much heat is spreading out and collecting in between Catra's legs, as long as she can keep Adora looking like that.

And yet, Adora has to ruin it, like she does everything else. "Catra you".Adora lets out a fake cough, as she tries to regain some stability in her voice. When she said Catra's name, it sounded almost desperate, airy, beautiful. Catra wants to hear her name said like that a thousand times over. "Y ou need to drink water. Now."Adora finally continues. She slowly scoots out from under Catra and stands.

Catra has changed her mind. She *hates* Adora now. Yeah, a few moments ago all she wanted to do was have Adora spiral out into a gasping mess beneath her touch, but now? Only hatred. Catra just wanted to sit here and rest, but now the warm and pillowy-soft thighs she was lying on have disappeared.

Catra groans loudly. "f I drink water will you shut up?"Catra slowly moves into a sitting position. She's achy everywhere.

"No. After that I need to get a fresh bandage on you and check you for other injuries."Adora says. Her voice is tinged with embarrassment, maybe, and a bit of sadness. She is facing away from Catra, so she can't see Adora' s face.

"Why do you need to do that? Ill be fine Adora. Stop worrying so much or you're gonna kill yourself." Catra finds that sitting up hurts her head. The even slight change in elevation from the ground causes her brain to pound with pain. She wants to argue more, she really does, but she can't.

"I just." Adora turns around, two water bottles in her hand and some granola bars in the other. "I didn't mean to hurt you, Catra. I have to fix this." Adora approaches her again, and plops down next to Catra. "The faster you let me help you the sooner I can stop."

Catra grunts. She didn't see any granola bars when she dragged Adora in here last night. Well, to be fair, she was pretty high on adrenaline and then deathly tired. "This is stupid, but fine," Catra says as she snatches the one of the water bottles out of Adora's hand. Catra untwists the lid and downs half of the bottle. It tastes like life. She didn't realize how dry her mouth was.

She looks over to see Adora sipping at her own water, and laying out the granola bars into an organized file, from largest to smallest. Adora looks at them intensely, trying to decide which ones to eat.

"Eat this one," Adora says as she gestures to one of the granola bars in her direction. Catra looks down at it.

"Why? You eat it." Catra protests.

"No, this one has the most protein, you need it to heal." Adora picks up the bar and shoves it into Catra's shoulder. Catra flinches. "Oh," Adora says as she rips back her hand, dropping the bar on the ground next to Catra. "I'm sorry."

"You've said that like a-fucking-million times. Just stop it already, Ill eat the goddamn bar moron." Catra mocks back. She's trying to make her voice sound annoyed, but she knows that contentment is seeping through. She likes bickering with her old friend like this, even if it's just a fleeting moment that will soon be lost to the war.

Catra takes the bar, unwraps it, and starts eating. Adora, after more consideration, picks out her own bar and starts eating as well.

~

After the two finish eating several granola bars to try and fill their appetite, Adora feels the need to keep attacking Catra with reqests.

"I need to replace that bandage Catra. Plus, when I did it last night, I didnt do it well enough. It needs to be tighter . Have you even cleaned it properly? I dont remember that happening. I bet you didnt. It' s going to get infected if we dont clean it. And-"Adora just goes on and on about how bad of a job Catra did at making sure she was okay. Who cares about her anyway? Catra will either be fine or wont be fine, and thatll be that.

"Fine. Just be careful, okay? And dont- I dont know , vomit when you see it."Catra warns. She adjusts herself to sit upright, her arms holding her up with her legs stretched out. "Y ou know I hate the water."Catra adds as Adora gets out a new water bottle and a *lot* of bandages.

"I wont. But youll let me?"Adora stammers out. She' s such a dork. Catra literally just said yes, but she has to ask over and over.

"The more you ask the more I want to say no. Just get it over with." Catra takes a shaky breath. Adora kneels down next to her and takes off the tape of the bandage and peels it off. It only stings a little bit from the movement. Just as Catra was thinking this was going to be fine, she hears Adora gasp next to her.

Catra looks over to find Adora's head down, eyes focused on Catra's cut. Catra feels soft fingers trace around it, she sharply inhales. It stings, but it almost feels nice. Adora's careful fingers even out the

pain of touching the wound. Catra grits her teeth together. She doesn't know if it's stopping her from screaming, running, or grabbing Adora and pulling her onto her lap, but it's stopping something.

"I'm so sorry . I'm so sorry I did this to you." Adora forces out. Her voice sounds wet.

"Stop it, Adora, it's not that bad. I'll live and I'll be fine. It doesn't matter." Catra wants to change the subject. Yeah, Adora did do that to her, and she will never forget the feeling of her skin ripping apart as easily as paper. But she doesn't want to have to deal with Adora feeling guilty. Adora can fix that in her own time.

"It's bad, Catra." Adora quietly remarks, her fingers still tracing along the wound.

"If it's so bad then put a fucking bandage over it!" Catra lashes out. She grabs Adora's wrist and pushes it back from her side. If Adora wants to act high-and-mighty, like she's so guilty and sorry, then she's gonna do it alone. Catra will not fuel that.

Adora silently moves on. She gets out the water bottle and starts to pour water over the cut. Catra flinches, her claws dig into the ground under her. She grits her teeth and tries to fight the sting. It hurts so much worse than it did last night. Maybe that's just because last night Catra barely cleaned it, but that's beside the point.

Catra whimpers in pain as Adora continues. Catra feels the water stop being poured, and for a moment she relaxes. Then she feels bandages rubbing into her open wound. Catra yelps.

"What the fuck are you doing?!" She hisses and lurches back, away from Adora.

"There's dirt in it. I need to get it out Catra!" Adora raises her voice up as she speaks.

"No you fucking dont! Y ou dont need to do anything okay?! Just let it be, if I get an infection and it kills me so what? Huh?!" Catra feels hot as she yells. This argument is costing her a lot of energy. Catra sighs. She needs to calm down otherwise her cut might open up again or something. "Y ou dont care, so dont even bother ."

It's true, isnt it? Adora might *think* she cares, she really might believe it, but Catra knows she doesnt. She almost pities Adora for it. If Adora just realized she didnt care, then everything would be so much easier. But instead, Adora still thinks she gives a fuck, and so she acts like it. It gives Catra slivers of hope, which only get crushed over and over when Adora's grand actions reveal how much of an afterthought Catra really is. Sure, maybe Adora will clean her wounds and make her stay hydrated, but who gets left behind again once the storm outside stops? Once Adora can go back to her *new friends?* She wont even hesitate to leave Catra again.

Adora groans in frustration and slams her fist on the ground. It startles Catra out of her thought spiral. "I do fucking care, Catra! Y ou really think I wanted to slash you? Just stay still and let me do this!" Adora grabs Catra's shoulder and pushes her to the ground. Catra doesnt fight back, even if she tried she wouldnt get very far . Adora forcibly rolls Catra onto her good side, her cut exposed and facing upwards for Adora to see.

Adora really is blind to her own emotions, isnt she? "Whatever , princess." Catra says, her voice is laced with sarcasm, but really , she is just horribly sad. She's run out of energy for this argument anyway. She might as well just suffer before Adora's hand, feeling her own heart break over and over once Adora abandons her again.

Adora runs more water over Catra's wound and scrubs at it aggressively. The room slowly fills with Catra's sounds, of pain, of displeasure, and of annoyance. Every once in a while Catra claws the ground so hard it's audible for the human ear, and Adora gives her a little break.

It’s almost as bad as torture, having the one you love’s hands roaming across your body, but it’s only to painfully clean a cut that *they* caused.

Adora lets out a breath, “I’m done cleaning it. There isn’t any soap here, so it’s not great, but it’s a lot better than it was. I cleaned some of the dried blood out of your fur, too.”

Catra doesn’t respond. She just softly shivers as she lays on the ground. Some of her fur is wet, and it makes her cold.

“Can you sit up now so I can bandage it?” Adora asks, hesitantly putting a hand on Catra’s shoulder as if she’s going to assist her. “We’re almost done, Catra.” She adds. She sounds so apologetic, so soft.

Catra rolls onto her back and looks at Adora. Adora is wearing a small smile on her face, but her lips quiver with uncertainty and her eyes scream sadness. What is making her so sad? Her big blue eyes pierce into Catra’s willing heart, every goddamn time. Adora’s hair is still down from when she fought it last night. Catra loves when it is down, beautifully resting over and across her shoulders.

“Okay,” Catra simply says. She sits up with Adora’s help (even though it is unneeded), and sits criss-cross next to her. Catra sets her hands down onto her knees. “Go ahead.”

Adora brings up the long bandage and presses it to Catra’s clean cut. It hurts, but she’s used to it by now, so she barely winces. Adora’s hands brush against Catra as she twists the bandage around her. Adora has to shift a little, and Catra can look down and see the top of Adora’s head near her hips, still winding the bandage around. Even though the room is filled with tension, sadness, and unspoken declarations, it feels calm right now.

Adora brings up the tape and secures the end of the bandage. It’s tighter on Catra than it was before, but she supposes that’s probably

good. Adora brings her head back up and doesnt back up when she is inches away from Catra's face.

"Thank you," Catra rushes out, her cheeks heating up. Why is Adora willingly so close to her? The best she's going to get is a forced *thank you* , that's it. Catra doesnt know what she' s expecting.

Adora places her hand onto an unwounded part of Catra's abdomen. "I never want to hurt you like that again. Please, dont let me. Whatever you need to do." Adora' s eyes well up with water. She closes her eyes and looks away, and it causes a few stray tears to escape.

Did Adora just tell her that? God, why does she have to be so perfect all the time? Of course, Adora would rather Catra kill her on the spot than injure her like that again. Adora's hand still rests on Catra. It radiates warmth, and safety. Adora radiates warmth and safety. Catra tells herself over and over again that Adora is her enemy, always will be, and that she can never go back. But, when the two are sitting, isolated together, it almost feels natural. Adora is so hurt by the fact that she cut Catra, even if she had no choice over it.

Catra brings up her hand and rests it on Adora's cheek that's now wet from tears. She guides Adora's head to look back at her. She doesnt know what to say to that. Just yesterday , Catra thought She-Ra was going to kill her, and then she thought that she killed Adora. Instead of using words, Catra decides to act. That was always her specialty, anyway.

Adora looks at her with wide eyes. Catra doesnt want to have to move her body, so she brings Adora's face closer by her cheek, Adora complies, almost eagerly. They are almost touching now, breathing in one another's air. It's intoxicating.

Catra closes the space with a little push. She presses forward and kisses Adora. It is soft. Everything about it is soft. The way Adora accepts her, the way Adora's hand doesnt move from Catra' s abdomen, but instead she rubs her fingers into her fur, the way

Adora's lips are softer than anything Catra could have ever imagined.

Suddenly, Adora pulls back. Catra opens her eyes again, her hand is still floating in the air, Adora's cheek missing from her palm. She finds Adora's face and sees her beet-red. "Are you okay with this?" Adora stutters and rushes out. She's shifting on her knees where she sits, obviously nervous.

Catra chuckles. "If I wasn't, why would I have pulled you in, idiot?" Catra brings her hand down from the air. Maybe this wasn't the time. But how else was Catra going to show Adora how she felt about her declaration of sacrifice? How else was she going to accept her apology?

"I just." Adora shifts more. "Will you tell me if I hurt you?"

Catra looks away. How much is Adora expecting from her? How much is she expecting to do? Catra starts to blush now, she can't help it. When Adora phrases something like that her brain starts imagining things.

"You're not gonna hurt me, Adora." Catra replies under her breath. She believes it, yeah, but it could still happen. What would Adora be doing anyway that might hurt Catra? She puts a hand onto Adora's thigh, and her muscles twitch under Catra's hand. "Just follow my lead." Catra murmurs. She watches Adora's face perk up a little bit at her words.

"Okay," Under all the nervousness, a faint smile rests on Adora's face. "I trust you."

What? Adora trusts her? After fucking everything, all the fighting, the teasing, the humiliation, and the hurt, Adora trusts that Catra won't lead her on, or make a fool out of her? No wonder fate picked Adora to become She-Ra. She really has a heart of pure *gold* . Catra has watched Adora and her new friends closely. Jealousy always causes the blood in her veins to come to a boil when she does, but she

watches for Adora. Her new friends seem nice enough, caring enough, but always focused on She-Ra and winning the war. Sure, that's important, but when Catra tries to count the number of hours she has sat, silently watching on a perch hidden from sight, she wonders how much of that time they were doing something Adora wanted to do. If they ever even *asked* what Adora wanted to do. Adora just blindly trusts that they mean well.

As much as Catra definitely *hates* Adora (definitely), she cant help but feel like no one treats her right. Catra feels like she, herself, got the closest to being what Adora wanted, what Adora needed, but obviously, she wasnt enough for her . Adora left. *Adora left.*

Catra shudders and shakes her head around, trying to untense her ears and face. For once, she needs to be in the moment. *This* moment. She never knows if she will get something like this again. Adora looks at her questioningly .

"If you tell anyone about this, I will kill you. For real this time."Catra chokes out, trying to gain some ground and confidence.

Adora laughs. Her laugh is light, soft, almost careful as to not overstep. It makes Catra's shoulders relax, her entire body just *gives* a little after hearing such a magical sound. "Sure, Catra. Whatever you say."Adora tries to stifle her giggling, and it turns into a few little sounds as Catra gives a glare.

Catra looks away for a moment, to give herself space. After all this fluffy talking, she feels awkward. Like, now she cant just jump on Adora, now it means something. Adora wants something. Is expecting something. Catra takes a deep breath. If she's learned anything from her experiences alone with Adora, it's that Adora *drinks* up Catra's confidence. Catra builds herself up for a moment. She knows Adora, and Adora knows her. Catra had obviously turned her on earlier after just kneading into her thigh. Adora had gotten so worked up, her face red, her thighs clenching together-

That’s all Catra needs to feel her want and confidence bubble up back into existence. Catra doesnt move in her seat, she’ s still sitting criss-cross, and she doesnt have to move. She knows Adora will come to her. Catra brings up her hand and rests it on Adora’s jaw. "Dont make me move, princess. Im wounded and need to rest, remember?"She teases, bringing her hand, and therefore Adora’ s face, closer.

Adora looks awestruck. She has looked like that a lot recently. Her eyes sparkle with curiosity and excitement. Catra hopes she can provide that for her.

Adora pushes closer, and their lips meet. This time, Adora is a little more forward. She was expecting it, after all. Catra inhales through her nose at the passion and leans back a little. It’s a lot for her. Her cut stings as she tries to hold herself up against the pressure. Adora, all too observing, starts to move. Their lips leave one anothers for only moments, as Adora comes up onto her knees, and then pulls one over to straddle Catra, and Catra complies, straightening out her legs. Adora’s body rests lightly on Catra’s. She can tell that Adora isnt putting her full weight on her .

Adora pulls back, just far enough so the kissing is forced to stop. "Is this okay?"She asks, her voice rough.

"Y es,"Catra says a little too fast. She doesnt want Adora to think she’s desperate, even though she *is* . Desperate for Adora’s touch, Adora’s lips, Adora’s everything. Whatever Adora will give her, Catra will gladly take.

Adora smiles brightly. Her cheeks are still dark, but Adora’s obviously more comfortable with it. Catra cant handle that smile, she cant handle being looked at with that much *emotion* . Catra grabs Adora’s shirt and tugs it in, meeting her and kissing her hard. Catra doesnt care how weak she is right now, she will show Adora who *should* be desperate. Adora wraps an arm around the small of Catra’s back and helps keep her sitting up. It feels gentle, yet assertive. Adora puts a little more of her body weight into Catra’s lap.

Catra wants more. This isnt enough. She moves her hands onto Adora's hips and pulls her down. Adora whimpers into Catra's mouth, and it sets her entire body on fire. She *needs* to hear more of that. Every part of her body screams to let her have this, the little voices that told her about safety and survival are gone. Catra pulls Adora's hips up, Adora moves eagerly and unquestioning, never leaving Catra's lips. She shifts one of her legs away and pushes Adora's hips back down to straddle against one of her thighs.

Adora gasps. Her grip on Catra's back tightens. She keeps holding Adora's hips and guides her to rock against Catra. Adora follows, pressing herself harder into Catra, and making strangled and desperate noises into her mouth. *Holy fuck* . Catra cant feel anything but need and ghosts of pleasure whenever Adora's knee brushes between Catra's legs as she moves. Her hands wander up Adora's sides, feeling up the curves of her body. Adora has gained muscle since she last saw her up close like this.

Catra wraps her hands around Adora's back and unsheathes her claws. She wants more noise out of Adora, and she wants her clothes off *now* . Adora halts her hips and pulls back from kissing as she hears ripping behind her. Catra only smirks up at her.

Adora's face is shined with sweat. Her cheeks are rosy, and her breath is coming fast. Catra continues to slice the back of Adora's shirt, and once she reaches the end, she watches it slump and start to fall down her shoulders. Adora looks down at herself, her shirt crumpled but still resting on her body, and she pulls the rest of the shirt forward and off.

Catra licks her lips at the sight of Adora almost naked. She's still wearing a sports bra, but her abs are enough to get Catra needy. Catra greedily slides her hands over Adora's exposed skin, causing Adora to shiver under her touch and whine. Catra tries to lean forward, and kiss Adora's neck, forcing the woman in front of her to unravel against her mouth, but Catra stops. She feels her wound stretch at the movement, and it hurts like hell. She pulls back and winces, quickly moving one of her hands over her bandage. Catra

cant have anything she wants, can she? Something always has to ruin everything, and that something is usually her own fault.

"Catra?" Adora bends down and wraps her arms around Catra's back softly, holding her up.

"It's fine," Catra chokes out. *Fuck*. Everything was just getting good. She fucking ruined it again with her high-maintenance bullshit. "Just moved wrong."

Adora tries to make eye contact with Catra, but Catra keeps her eyes locked on the wall next to them. "Here," Adora tries to make her voice peppy, like Catra isnt a bother. "I'll get of f-"

"No!" Catra interrupts, turning her head back and finally looking at Adora again. Adora looks a mix of confused, concerned, and still turned on. "I dont want to stop. I just cant move around a lot."

Adora smiles. Maybe she doesnt want to stop either. "Okay, lie down for me?" She suggests. Catra's cheeks start to burn once more. *Fuck her*. Being in a position like that is a lot of vulnerability. But, something in her brain is telling her that if Adora really was going to do something, she would've already done it. Another voice is telling her that this is what Adora wants, to be trusted, so she can take advantage. Catra doesnt know which voice is louder, which voice is right.

Catra lets her body give into Adora's hands at her back, leaning into the touch. Adora takes that as a yes, and leans forward, Catra still in her arms, and rests her body on the floor of blankets. Catra relaxes once she is set on the ground. She didnt really make a decision, but she knows this is the right one. She tries to mentally strangle the voice that tells her to give into paranoia, to never trust another. That may be true a lot of times, but why would Adora try to take such good care of Catra just to stab her in the back? Adora isnt like that, she never was, and she never will be.

"I'll be gentle," Adora says as she lets her hands wander across Catra's sides. Catra has been shirtless for a long time now, and her skin was aching to be touched like this ever since she remembered what Adora's hands felt like. Catra lets her body arch up into Adora's touch. Her fingers sift through Catra's fur, climbing up and down her sides, avoiding the bandage or anything that may hurt.

Catra doesn't realize she's making noise until she is graced with Adora's lips on hers and whines into her mouth. Adora moans back. Catra can't handle that. She's already soaking, but Adora's noises destroy her. The fact that Adora is actually enjoying this, feeling things that Catra is feeling, could get her off all alone. Adora is braced above Catra on her elbow, her other hand traces over Catra's cheek and jaw now, caressing her like she's priceless.

Adora's hand wanders. It wanders down, lightly passing over Catra's breast, and then down her stomach, and it finally rests on Catra's inner thigh. Adora experiments, letting her fingers trace, then squeezing and massaging Catra there, but never reaching where Catra really *wants* it.

Catra pulls back from the kiss, her breath heavy. "Adora," She breathes out. "Strip me."

Adora's eyes widen. She eagerly lifts off of Catra, and thumbs her waistband. "You sure?" Adora adds. She's obviously nervous. Adora probably doesn't know what the hell she's doing.

"Don't make me ask twice, princess." Catra demands. Her voice is raw, but she forces confidence and urgency into it. Adora continues, moving out of the way and pulling Catra's skin-tight pants off. Catra wonders if Adora can tell how wet she is.

Adora shudders and stares at Catra. She stumbles on her words. "Should- Uh, should I take..." She stares at Catra's underwear and licks her lips. That sets Catra on fire. How can one person be so attractive?

"Please," Catra breathes, it comes out a lot more desperate than she hoped it would. She props up on her elbows to watch. She likes watching her figure make Adora so eager, so needy. Adora pulls her underwear down and then throws it to the side, and stares. Catra blushes. Why is she staring so much? What is she thinking? Catra knows she's wet, Adora doesn't have to rub it in.

"You're beautiful." Adora squeaks out. She rubs her hands up and down Catra's thighs. It causes Catra's hips to twitch a little.

"If I'm going to be naked, then you are too." Catra says, smiling at Adora below her. She doesn't want to be the only one so exposed. It doesn't matter if Catra isn't going to be able to touch Adora that much, she still wants to *see.*

Adora's hands stop in their tracks. "You want me naked?" She nervously laughs, looking around the room for something to distract her. Catra smiles harder, at least Adora is as scared as she is.

"Yes. Make it a show for me, princess." Catra brings her arm up and gestures up and down Adora's body. Adora's flush spreads over the top of her tits, it's gorgeous.

Adora silently stands up. Even though Catra is looking up at Adora, she still feels safe, in control, and like she isn't going to be ambushed. Adora pulls down her pants and swings it off of her legs. She then grabs the hem of her sports bra and pulls it off. Her body moves gracefully, yet still tense. As she stretches up to get her bra over her body, her back arches. Catra watches, shifts, and squeezes her thighs together. As Adora throws the bra across the room, Catra truly gets to marvel at her breasts. They're flush since Adora has been blushing so much. Her nipples are hard, and her body curves perfectly. Adora then bends down and pulls her underwear off. Catra must've not been paying that much attention, because she can easily see how turned on Adora is. Her thighs are damp.

Adora kneels back down and crawls closer to Catra. Is Adora trying to kill her? Because if she keeps doing shit like that, Catra might just

pass out.

Adora stops in between Catra's legs. "W as that good?"She asks, her voice is filled with insecurity. Maybe Catra has been overthinking this. Maybe Adora just, simply, wants this too and is just as inexperienced.

"Come here,"Catra reaches out, and Adora follows, resting her head on Catra's hand. She pulls her closer, and kisses Adora gently. "Y es. I *loved* it."Adora smiles brightly and hums in happiness.

Adora moves to kiss Catra's neck. Catra's body immediately lights up. She can feel Adora's exposed skin press into her own. Catra wraps her arms around her back, and makes sure her claws are sheathed. She pulls Adora closer. Feeling Adora's body against hers is like a drug. Adora's kisses turn rougher. Catra *moans* under her, and Adora responds with a hand falling down Catra's body and resting just above where Catra needs to be touched.

Adora's hand is almost there, but unmoving. She's probably too scared to touch Catra for real. Catra's too turned on to not be touched. She grabs Adora's wrist and moves her lower. Adora gasps at the same time Catra softly moans as Adora's fingers finally trace over her folds.

"T ouch me, Adora."Catra whispers into her ear . She lets go of Adora's wrist. "I'll tell you how I like it."Catra can feel Adora' s breath on her neck. It's warm and fast and makes Catra shiver. Adora moves her fingers around, tracing over Catra's entrance, and then her clit. Catra whines and arches into every touch, every movement. Her hips twitch with excitement, with *need* .

Adora starts to kiss Catra's neck again, and it makes her *need* burn harder. She cant keep waiting for Adora to gain confidence. "Adora," Catra whines against her. "Inside, please."She almost begs. Her voice is strained. Her body screams for release, even though she's barely been touched. Catra has always been sensitive. She cant

stop herself from asking like this. She knows its weak, but fuck, does it feel good to be weak right now.

Adora traces over Catra's entrance one last time, and Catra can feel how slick she is, before she finally pushes one finger in. Catra's body takes it easily, without any hesitation. It's almost disappointing. She doesnt feel enough. "More," She whimpers, shifting her hips into Adora's touch.

Adora pulls out a little and then pushes a second finger in. *Much better* . Catra moans at the feeling. Adora's fingers are longer than hers, and it feels so much better than whenever Catra fucks herself. Catra arches up to try and take more of whatever Adora can give her. She wiggles and whines as Adora moves in and out slowly. It would almost be torture if it didnt feel so fucking good.

Catra pants, she needs more. "Harder , faster Adora, please. I can take it." She chokes out. Adora whines into Catra' s neck and nods eagerly. She pumps faster and rougher. Every push hurts Catra's wound just a little bit, but it's worth it. Catra can ignore the stings of pain for the overwhelming feeling of pleasure radiating between her legs.

Catra's noises grow louder and more embarrassing. The room fills with whines and moans, most coming from Catra, and some coming from Adora. Catra pushes her head forward a little, and sinks her teeth into Adora's neck. Adora, apparently, *loves* that. She loudly moans at the pain and starts to move faster in and out of Catra.

So Adora likes a little pain, huh? Adora's moans, compiled with her ever-qickening pace, is pushing Catra close to the edge. But she knows she needs more, just a little bit. She takes one of her hands off Adora's back and lets it fall to rub her clit. Catra's body immediately responds with lightning bolts of pleasure, almost coming just from a few touches. Catra's claws unsheath a little, without her knowledge, as she grips Adora's back trying to brace and steady herself. Adora initially sounds startled at the claws, but her sounds qickly turn to moan-filled-winces. The fact that Adora is enjoying

fucking her, is enjoying being touched and scratched up by her, sends Catra over the edge.

She gasps out, and then quickly bites back down onto Adora's neck, trying to stifle her chance at loudly *moaning Adora's name.* Catra's claws continue to dig into Adora's back as her body ripples with pleasure. It shoots from her legs and fills her up with warmth and satisfaction. She shakes a little, under Adora, as the pleasure settles down and her body gives way into relaxation.

At some point, Adora took her fingers out, but Catra doesn't know when. She's barely even in her body right now, her post-orgasm haze hitting her harder than ever. She then notices that Adora is next to her, holding Catra softly. And finally, as Catra returns to Etheria mentally, she hears herself purring. Or well, it sounds more like an engine roaring. It's loud and fills the room, and when she opens her eyes to look at Adora, she's giggling.

"What?" Catra protests through her purr, it makes her voice deep and rumbly.

"I haven't heard you purr like this in a long time, that's all," Adora explains, her face flush and her smile spilling happiness all around her.

Catra lets her purr continue. She knows it's embarrassing, and an obvious tell of her emotions, but Adora likes it. Catra, deep down, likes it too. She stares at Adora for a moment and then lets her eyes fall down her figure. Her gaze stops at the sight of Adora's things, still wet, or even more so than before. She wants to make Adora feel the way she did, but logically, she doesn't have the strength to do that. Her hands feel weak after touching herself and gripping Adora's back. Actually, her entire body feels weak from the exertion.

Catra gets an idea. She wants to hear Adora's sounds, be here and make her feel good, but she doesn't necessarily have to be the one actually fucking her. "Turn over." Catra demands, her voice still rough with the purr. She doesn't care. Her message will get across.

"Okay?" Adora agrees, her face confused as she turns over to face the opposite way of Catra.

"Now come here." Catra adds, putting a hand on Adora's hip and lightly tugging her, to show her what she wants. Adora scoots in, and presses herself against Catra's hips, chest, *everything* . They are practically flush together.

"What, you wanted to cuddle more? You could've just said that, Catra." Adora laughs a little as she settles in.

Catra moves her head closer, her lips graze over Adora's ear. "Hmm, maybe." She pauses, letting out hot hair onto Adora's neck. "Touch yourself for me, princess." She breathes.

Catra can feel Adora immediately tense, and she can easily hear her breathing become uneven. Adora shifts her legs apart a little, allowing access, and brings her hand down to her own clit. Adora sets off at a quick pace, without any build-up. Well, she probably had build-up from fucking Catra, actually.

"No," Catra whispers. "Start slow ."

Adora whimpers and slows her fingers down. Catra takes this time to explore. She brings her hand over Adora's side, letting her claws lightly trace over her skin. She can see the scratches she left in Adora's back, no blood drawn. Adora's desperate whines turn to moans as she speeds up her pace. Adora must've really enjoyed fucking Catra, because she's already a needy and twitching mess after just a few minutes. Catra continues, letting her claws scratch a little harder. She brings her hand down to Adora's thigh and traces there. She knows it's sensitive, and set Adora off earlier today.

Adora's skin is perfect. It's soft, squishy , and smooth. She has her share of blemishes and birthmarks, but that only makes her prettier. She trusts herself in Catra's arms like this. Adora is weak for her.

Catra grabs. She takes a handful of Adora's thigh and lets her claws *dig* . It causes Adora to, suddenly, moan out and shake. Her body twitches more than it ever had before. Catra moves her arms to hug Adora close, offering comfort as she comes.

"Mmm, good. I got you, Adora." Catra whispers. Her voice spills with affection. She hopes that Adora is too taken up with pleasure to notice.

Catra hears a softened, strangled *Catra* come from Adora, a noise enveloped in a moan.

Adora's body goes limp, and her hand falls out of her legs. She gives a contented sigh, and Catra keeps her arms wound around Adora. Catra lets herself stay. Something tells her to leave, get out, that it's not safe, but Adora is at peace and calm in her arms, so she doesn't pry herself away. Adora wiggles a little and flips over. They're face-to-face now. Adora is smiling and incredibly flush.

Catra is telling herself: *don't scent mark, don't scent mark, don't set mark* , over and over again. And guess what her stupid head does? Scent marks. She leans in and rubs her cheek against Adora's jaw, neck, basically anywhere she can get without moving too much. She hears Adora start to giggle as she marks. Adora's laugh sounds like what Catra imagines heaven to be like.

Catra finally pulls back, happy with her work, and Adora puts her hand on Catra's cheek. The gesture is filled with care, and Adora leans in and kisses her. It's soft. If Catra didn't know better , she might call it *loving* . Adora pulls back from the kiss and continues to stare into Catra's eyes. Adora gives her *that* look, the look of hope combined with a tinge of nervousness.

Adora gets up. Catra starts to panic for a moment, and Adora notices. "I'm just putting on some clothes, it's cold." Adora snickers as she moves. She puts her underwear and shirt back on. Catra actually thinks that's a good idea. As much as she loves being free of fabric, it is pretty cold.

"Gimme some clothes too," Catra suggests as she turns a little. She's still not going to get up. Adora tosses Catra her underwear, and then she looks down at Catra's shirt. She hasn't worn it in a while. It's heavily stained with blood and ripped open at the side. Catra notices her looking.

"Hm." Adora considers, deeply staring into the shirt. "Ooh!" She proclaims as she walks over to her classic red jacket. Adora grabs it, and then holds it out to Catra. "Wear this instead?"

Catra feels her heart skip a beat. She needs to stop it from doing that. Adora is so oblivious of anything, Catra is sure she is just doing this because it's nice, and it doesn't mean anything more. She needs to stop looking for *more* in Adora's actions. Nonetheless, Catra grabs the jacket. "Okay," She says, almost breathlessly. When did she start breathing hard and blushing? Adora giggles at her and continues about the room.

Catra puts on the jacket. It's a tiny bit big for her, but nothing too noticeable. *My god*. It smells of Adora, obviously, but Catra immediately feels safe once she inhales it. It's so strong, has Adora ever washed this thing? Well, it doesn't matter, because Catra is loving the scent it gives off. Catra hugs herself around the jacket.

Adora comes back and sits down next to Catra again, and hands her a new water bottle. She chuckles at the sight of Catra practically head-over-heels about Adora's jacket. "You like it?"

Catra grunts. She isn't going to give Adora a *real* response. She doesn't want to lie, but she also doesn't want to admit that, *yes*, Catra absolutely loves it and wants to keep it forever and never take it off. Adora smiles and drinks some of her water, and Catra does the same. She doesn't really want to drink anything, but Adora would be mad at her if she didn't stay hydrated.

Catra still feels all fuzzy inside. She knows that Adora really cares about her healing and staying healthy right now, but she doesn't want to do that. "Adora?" Catra asks.

Adora looks at her and cocks her head to the side. It's fucking adorable. "Yeah?"

"Can we just..." Catra pauses and looks down at the bed-nest-thing below them. "Lie down together for a while?" Her cheeks burn after she speaks. It's embarrassing to ask for something like this. She can't find an excuse to make it non-affectionate in her brain. Adora's perfect blue eyes sparkle at her.

"Of course. We can stay for however long you want." Adora replies. She takes another gulp of water and then tosses it aside. She lies down next to Catra, who's still sitting up, and looks at her. Maybe Adora really does care.

Catra is a little shocked. Adora was so willing and so considerate. She didn't hesitate, and now she's lying in acceptance and waiting for Catra to be ready. Catra puts her water aside and lies next to Adora, looking at her. Catra's heart feels full. Her entire body feels warm. Her emotional walls fall down whenever she's around Adora for long periods of time. It's scary, yeah, but she's already done so many scary things today, so this isn't so bad.

Adora opens her arms up, silently asking Catra to scoot in. Catra does, and nuzzles her head into Adora's neck. Adora wraps an arm around Catra's back and then lets one arm cradle her head. Catra's all wrapped up. She's being treated like a person. She notices that Adora starts to pet her ears. She must've been telling the truth about how much she liked them.

Catra lets her eyes close as she breathes in Adora, as she breathes in what almost feels like *love*.

~

Catra opens her eyes. It’s a bit cold, but that’s expected. She smells Adora, but she cant see her at the moment. That’ s okay. It felt like she only closed her eyes for a second, but she probably fell asleep at some point. Catra turns and looks around the room, looking for Adora. She finds nothing. She sits up.

“Adora?” She asks the cold, empty room. She smells her , so why isnt she-

Catra looks down at the jacket she’s still wearing. That’s where the scent is coming from. Catra looks around again. Adora couldnt have just left after all of that, right? She moves onto all fours, and slowly pushes herself to stand. It hurts, but it’s a lot better than it was. She always was a fast healer.

Catra looks at one of the benches and sees her pants, her shirt, a blanket and her own jacket folded up, a bottle of water and a granola bar resting next to it. She’s confused. She hasnt walked in a while, so she shuffles across the room. Her brain is still foggy from sleep. She cranks open the door to the bunker. Cold air floods into the room and strikes Catra in the face. It’s fucking freeing out there. But, she sees that the sun is up and the weather is clear. Catra can see the rock that she dragged Adora over from just a couple of days ago, and it looks so close now that there isnt a blizzard raging around.

The cold wind shakes through the small room as Catra just stares out into the white landscape before her. She feels her cheeks start to become wet. Then her vision gets a little blurry. She’s crying. Why is she crying?

Catra’s hand is holding the door open, and she starts to feel pain spread up her arm. She looks at her hand and notices the death-grip she’s giving the door. She lets go and looks down at her hands. The cold air burns her lungs and eyes as it blows on her.

Adora is gone.

Catra watches her hands as she closes them into fists. Pain shoots out of her hands and up her body as her claws unsheath and dig into her palms.

Adora left her.

She looks back up and out into the snow. She was such a fucking idiot. Who the fuck was she to think anyone was showing genuine care, genuine *love* for her? She's not worth it. She's been proved that over and over again. So why the fuck cant she get over it, and understand that whenever she feels loved, it is a momentary lapse of someone's judgment. It' s a mistake.

Adora doesnt care about her .

Catra turns around to the bench where Adora laid out her stuff. She walks over to it, still in Adora's jacket. She grits her teeth.

Catra, claws completely unsheathed, rips through the clothes. She tears the bench along with it. Her claws grind into the cold metal that the bench is made out of. The fabric shreds easily. She grabs the water bottle and throws it as hard as she can into the wall.

Catra screams into the room. The noise bounces off of the walls and pierces right back through her ears. She hears how she sounds. The scream is shaking, it's wet, it's just fucking pathetic. She's pathetic.

She falls to her knees and rips up the bed that Adora made for the two of them. She destroys it. She throws her body back to her feet and feels pain start to slowly flood through her body. It doesnt matter. If Adora didnt care to stay , why should Catra care to heal? She grabs the shelves that line one of the walls and tears it down. It slams into the floor, blankets, and pillows, medkits, and supplies are thrown everywhere. She trusts her hands into the wall and claws down it. The metal that she tears up is jagged and cuts her fingers.

She looks at her hands. Theyre bloody now . Adora would be mad at her for doing this. But Adora isnt here, is she? She couldve been

here. But she chose to leave. Catra walks to the open door that lets cold wind rock through the room. She looks out. Her legs give out under her.

She grips the floor and lets her claws dig into it once more. It helps. Catra finally feels the sharp pain thats coming from her side. She looks over at her bandage and sees little splotches of blood on it. Her wound mustve opened back up as she threw herself around.

She can still smell Adora on her. It's the jacket, but its also stuck on her fur.

She manages to hold herself back from cutting the jacket off of her. Her tears hit the floor.

"Why not me, Adora?" Catra's voice strangles out. It's raw from the scream. It's weak.

Adora really just let all that happen, and then left. She's probably going to tell all her *new friends* about how weak Catra is. She's going to go to The Rebellion and tell them how stupid Catra must be. How Adora played her for days. Catra cant believe herself. She cant believe she let herself trust like that again.

Catra forces herself to stand. Her head is screaming at her for all the mistakes she made. Everything she showed Adora. She's always going to leave Catra, again and again. She's always going to put something, or someone, else over her. Catra is never the first priority.

She moves her legs forward and starts to walk out into the snow. It's a lot colder when there arent any walls around her. Her bare legs and chest dont help. Her feet sting and start to numb because of the snow. She probably isnt too far from the Northern Reach base.

Catra holds herself as she walks. As much as she knows Adora doesnt care for her, doesnt give a shit about her, she knows she still loves Adora. She inhales the jacket that she's wearing. Half of her is

angry because of the constant betrayal. She gave so much away to Adora, and Adora just took and left. But, another part of her is just sad. She’s hopeless. She’s not worth anyone’s time.

Shell show Adora. She will show her that even if no one ever cares about Catra, that doesnt matter . Catra doesnt need anyone else. She doesnt need someone to help her , care for her, *love* her. The only person that truly did that for her was Adora. And Adora is gone. Catra will never give like that again. Catra will never give Adora another chance to leave her.

Chapter End Notes

> I know I say thank you like at every endnote but I mean it :(
> I didnt plan for it to end on sadness and angst and stuf f, but it honestly just felt right when I was thinking about how to finish it off. Anyway, I hope you enjoyed reading

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